

Romans 16:1-12
Workers in the Lord

Introduction:

We all recognize the now famous line by John F. Kennedy, in what now is part of “Americana” and American folklore--“Ask not of what your country can do for you, ask what you can do for your country...”

In short, Kennedy assumed a national purpose that transcends individual comforts... and perhaps most amazingly, and for the most part, American buys in to it!

But what if this same line were applied to the church? Would we buy into it? E.g. How does it make you feel if I were to announce to you today as concerning the “church” sphere of institution “ask not of what your church can do for you, but what you can do for your church.”

I can already begin to hear the “manipulation” radars turning my way... we are all programmed as it were, perhaps understandably, to be skeptical about motives and agendas as related to the church especially. We are, and let's be honest, intuitively cynical toward pastors and church leaders—wondering honestly if there isn't some hidden agenda that is less than noble behind the ambitions...

And so, we come to a sermon like this—one that is to focus on the meaning of church as per our own involvement and commitment...

And I offer this challenge to you—

- 1) Go ahead and focus your manipulation radar on me—you should check out every word as per the counsel of scripture....
- 2) But do so with at least a slight opening in your heart to consider the teachings of the scripture as we will encounter them in our text today, as read within the greater context of NT theology especially...

To be sure, after our worship service today we will have a

congregational meeting, and one of the major tasks will be to nominate ‘servant leadership’ in our church...

Therefore, my “agenda” is very simple and unhidden—it is to put into Biblical context the notion of “servant leadership in the church.”

Beyond even this—to put into Biblical context the notion of the so called “priesthood of believers”—wherein it is affirmed that the new temple is the church and is an essential element of the gospel, wherein everyone is a “priest” onto God... in their worship of service as according to the distribution of gifts to the church by God!

And the goal is also plainly set—it is my hope that you will be convinced from scripture—that it is your duty to God, to use your gifts in service to him *IN AND FOR THE CHURCH, AS IN THE OTHER TWO SPHERES OF CALLING AS WELL..*

Exposition:

I. Two sections with General Observations:

1. vs. 1-2: Specific Recommendation

“commend... so that you may receive... so that you will help in whatever she may require from you...”

vs. 1: recommend...” as in to “endorse” and “delegate” responsibility to someone... so that in

vs. 2: “receive her” ... e.g. her service...

a) Notice carefully the terms of his recommendation

- As “in the Lord”
- in a manner worthy of the saints...” e.g. as the work that a saint can and should do that is exemplary... “saint” is used in the NT to describe any “Christian”—those “set apart” in Christ... “ (not “saint” as a special class of Christians per se) Again, Her “status” is as a “Christian sister”—(note 1Cor.7:15, 9:5, Philem 2, James 2:15)

E.g. a ministry that is recognized as “The Lord’s work” even as a work that is “worthy of the everyday Christians...”

b) Notice also that her service involved some form of leadership:

“and assist her in whatever matter she may have need of you” —
= *assist* as in to “stand by here, help, come to her aid assist...
= *pragma*—is left unspecific, clearly not as would be expected if this were a recognized “office” in the church with a specific “calling” relative to one task more or less (as in teaching, ruling relative to pastor and elder)... the term simply refers to some undertaking, task, matter, affair... a pretty open ended recommendation—she is given some freedom it seems to determine what she will need—again, clear, she is a leader, if not holding an apostolic appointed office...

c. Notice therefore, status is as a “deacon of the church”

Deacon-- the term in and of itself could be understood simply in terms of a regular pattern of service undertaken by Phoebe on behalf of her local church (13:4), 15:8, 12:7)—or it could also have expressed a recognized ministry or perhaps even “office” of some sort... so as to carry some sort of position of responsibility...

Note:

Διακονέω (verb)

- a. care for, take care of, 2 Cor.3:3
- b. help, support someone, Mt25:44, LK.8:3, Rom.15:25
- c. serve, 2 Tim.1:18, 2 Cor.8:19-20,

διακονία (adj)

- a. service, Eph.4:12, 2 Cor.11:8, 1 Cor.16:15; 2 Tim.4:11
- b. specifically service necessary for preparation of a meal, Luke 10:40
- c. service of the prophets and apostles, 1 Tim.1:12, Acts 1:17
- d. aid, support, distribution esp. of gifts/money Acts. 6:1, 11:29, 2 Cor. 9:12
- e. of the office of deacon, Rom.12:7

διακονος(noun)

- a. servant of someone, helper, Mt. 20:26, Eph. 3:7, Col.1:25, 1 Th.3:2, Tit. 1:9, Eph. 6:21, Col. 4:7, Rom. 15:8
- b. deacon as an official of the church, 1 Tim.3:8, 12

Regardless of whether or not the term is here used to denote a specific office or not (although probably not given the above unspecified task) in so far as the Roman church is concerned, she carried some responsibility such as to deserve Paul’s recommendations! Thus at the very least, while not holding to an

office, holding to some recognized leadership relative to her service.. thus our term “servant leader”

- that a women was active in some sort of leadership in religious organizations of that day is not so odd actually—they were for instance active in religious cults of the time, particular that of Isis in that over 1/3 of the devotees of Isis named in inscriptions in Italy are female...

2. vs. 3-16, 21: General Greetings:

“Greet” (over 20 times in chapter 16)—the section concludes the letter to Rome by Paul, penned by his helper Tertius... and is most essential a “greetings” section...

General Observation:

First, most are ordinary people in the church... second, most are in some way identified as “workers in the church”

E.g. the list consists not of “ordained” ministers—but the kind of cross section of people one would expect in a “city”

church—several husband/wife pairings... young converts, Gentiles and Jews, nameless family members of various people are mentioned several times... a prominent citizen, some were relatives of Paul’s, brothers and sisters of various folks that are mentioned... even “all the saints” ... to be sure, this is no formal greeting of formal or “ordained” members of the clergy, not even greetings relative to ordained lay people...

To be sure, what is most striking about these greetings is just how “ordinary” are these people are who evidently had had a great impact in Paul such as to be remembered by Him and a great impact in the churches that are mentioned such as in Cenchrae, the church in various houses in Rome.. even “all the churches” of Christ...

E.g. It is perhaps unfortunate that I should point out how the List does include women:

The list of 28 servant leaders, no less than nine are women—seven by name, three of them among the first five and four of them noted for their hard work or “leading role”...

To be sure, there is much to talk about and appreciate regarding the Biblical ministries of women in the church. Throughout the New Testament scriptures, women are recognized and celebrated in their strategic roles within the apostolic church. One thinks of the “elect lady” to whom John writes his second epistle, or the *διακονον*, Phoebe, who was especially recommended to the Roman church in order to secure their help in whatever strategic ministry she was engaged in in Romans 16. There was Tabitha and Dorcas who made “coats and garments” for the impoverished widows in Acts 9. There were the *Πρεσβύτιδας*, or “elder-widows” in 1Tim.5:2, 9ff and Titus 2:3ff or, depending on your interpretation of 1 Timothy 3:11, there was the strategic role of “deacons wives/deaconesses” who, regardless of how one understands this passage, were doing something so important as to warrant an examination of qualifications. One thinks of the women who “evangelized” the disciples concerning the resurrection of the Lord, even though the disciples found it difficult to believe (Luke 24:10). One thinks of Mary Magdalene, Johanna and Susanna and many other women who “ministered” to Jesus with their possessions and through their services, both during His lifetime and after His death.¹ There were the women who joined with the apostles in the upper room for prayer and supplication in Acts 1:13. And of course were the many strategic women who were significant enough to receive Paul’s explicit greetings and commendations in his pastoral letters to the churches, such as in the Roman’s epistle where we hear of Priscilla, Paul’s “fellow worker” (Rom.16:3), Mary “who labored much” (Rom.16:6), Junia who because of her labors in the Lord was a “fellow prisoner” with Paul (Rom.16:7), Tryphena and Tryphosa who also “labored in the Lord, together with Persis (Rom.16:12). Indeed, the notations go on and on throughout the apostolic record such that to say that woman played a strategic role in the apostolic church is at best an understatement

E.g. Most especially then, returning to the list as a whole-- The List is saturated with service/work kinds of language as related to their role in the churches...

- No less than 6 times the language of “workers/co-workers” is used...

- Husband wife team who “worked with Paul and who “risked their lives for him, evidently such as to not only evoke Paul’s gratefulness, but also the churches (plural) of the Gentiles... who evidently had opened their housing complex to hosting one of the churches...
- Some are described as those who not only “worked” but “worked hard” in their midst...
- And the point is not so much what they did as the fact that they were doing something! Eg. Only rarely in this long list of greetings, is anything at all noted about what these people did—to be sure, some are noted as being in prison, some are noted as “beloved” in the Lord or even “beloved” by Paul... but evidently, and perhaps other than Phoebe, it was not the point of the passage exalt any one task or any on job/work in the churches—it was rather to exalt the many “workers...”

Most significantly:

- They are often described as co-workers in Christ (9), or “workers in the Lord (12) or “those who “worked hard in the Lord” (12)—evidently joining Paul at some level.

Summary: all of this is in the context of “workers in the Lord”—those who do the Lord’s work, even if they are not preaching and teaching... or leading liturgy—all are as priests...

III. Question:

Question all of this raises, and especially this last point concerning their “work” as then described as “in Christ” and “in the Lord” is this: —Does all of this fit into a category of teaching by Paul in this epistle? E.g. How do we locate these observations theologically.

E.g. Whereas it is fairly obvious and common to associate the work of those filling an ordained office (pastor or elder) with doing “the Lord’s work” or as here “workers in the Lord,” is there a theological idea that supports Paul’s otherwise casual associations between these “common workers” and “the Lord’s work...?”

¹ Luke 8:2-3 & 23:56 to 24:10.

Romans 12:1-5—*Priesthood of Believers*

Vs/ 1" Therefore...

Paul indicates that the eshortation follows from what has gone before—from chaps 9-11 as much as from chaps 5-8... and especially the imperatives follows from the logic of th gospel... especially in so far as the gospel has created a “new temple” whereby Christian living is now a sacred calling!

I. Cultic dimension of the law has been annuled: 3-9 esp.

That dimension which gave Israel it's cultic identity and meaning. (temple worship (ceremonial) and national (civil) aspects of Torah have been annuled in Christ.

II. vs.1: "Therefore, I exhort you...

Imperatives are based upon the indicative of previous chapters.

1. Doctrinal indicatives: Chapters 6-8

Language is very close to the language in Chapters 6-8.

Ex. Rom. 6:13: "do not present your members to sin as instruments of wickednes, but present yourselves to God... and your members to God as instruments of righteousness."

Same word "present"

Same antithesis as in vs.2

Rom.8:10: "But if Christ is in you, although your bodies are dead because of sin, your spirits are alive because of righteousness."

Same word "body" (sacrifice language)

2. Redemptive Historical Indicatives:

Teaching about redemptive history:

New redemptive period that is the fulfillment of the old.

a. Rom.2:28-29- "For he is not a real Jew who is one outwardly, nor is true circumcision something external and physical. He is a Jew who is one inwardly, and real circumcision is a matter of the heart, spiritual and not literal."

New cultic standards. No longer according to the

letter of the law.

b. vs. 1: Priestly language: Sacrificial, cultic language.

- "present"

- "your body"

- "living, holy, sacrifice"

- "worship"

From circumcision of the flesh (ceremonial, national aspect of law embodied in this ordinance) to circumcision of the heart. No more ethnic boundary. New Sacrificial ritual.

c. The significance of "Ritual" in 1st century:

"group identity"

"Participation in groups distinctive cultic rituals marked the participants as belonging to the group."

Thus, the historic “priesthood of believers” theology of life...

Notice the cultic language then that is here applied as predicated upon earlier cultic/communal formation and transition given the gospel teachings...

E.g.

Parastasia—recalling 6:13, 16, 19 (present—as in an offering)

Somata—recalling 6:6, 12, 7:4, 24 and 8:10, 11, 13, 23... (body—as in sacrifice...)

E.g. Christians must live as those being transformed, yet within this age, and within the consequent eschatological tension, in an age wherein the new temple is being formed.. as by our service... even as the new temple spoken of in Rev. is yet to be fully completed!

Therefore, in the age of tension—wherein the New and heavenly temple is both now and not yet— in an age wherein all believers are as “priests” in the formation of this temple, not merely a select few as from a seslect tribe-- we are to offer ourselves as offerings to its formation... this is Paul’s point in Rom 12...

So then, based on the formation of a new temple by the gospel of Jesus Christ, we are to OFFER ourselves “a sacrifice, living, holy, acceptable to God”

Meaning of vs. 1- NIV: "your spiritual act of worship."

Same word that our word "logical" is derived.

Translators: Attempting to relate vs.1-2 back to
Romans 2:28-29, a different kind of cultic identity,
worship that is life changing, not just ritualistic.

***Better translation: "your reasonable worship"

- a. Fits what follows: "mind"
- b. Fits the transition: "in light of what has been already taught both doctrinally and redemptive historically, this is the most logical way of understanding worship."
- c. Fits the diverse gifts description—e.g. reasonable relative to who you are in the church given God's distribution of gifts...

Vs. 3ff is then a general statement as to the fact that all of us, while not all called to preach, teach, lead worship, etc. we are all part of the cultic mandate in so far as we have all been given "grace" in order that we are all part of God's temple administration!

Thus, from cultic ritual to cultic living involving the whole of the community of faith..

Thus, just as the great commission is given to the whole church as founded by the apostles upon Christ... so too the temple consists of all who believe...

As then noted by our own Confession:

Communion of Saints

John 13:33-35; 17:21; 1 Thess.3:12, 1 John 3:11;

WCF 26

1. All saints, that are united to Jesus Christ their head, by his Spirit, and by faith, have fellowship with him in his graces, sufferings, death, resurrection, and glory: and, being united to one another in love, they have communion in each other's gifts and graces, and are obliged to the performance of such duties, public and private, as do conduce to their mutual good, both in the inward and outward man.

2. Saints by profession are bound to maintain an holy fellowship and communion in the worship of God, and in performing such other spiritual services as tend to their mutual edification; as also in relieving each other in outward things, according to their several abilities and necessities. Which communion, as God offereth opportunity, is to be extended unto all those who, in every place, call upon the name of the Lord Jesus.

(See also John Calvin: Institutes Book IV, Ch.1.3)

This then brings us to Rom. 16...

IV. *Ecclesia*:

Returning again to our passage—we must not then miss the clear references to a "temple" theology as from the context of Romans 12...

E.g. Notice the frequent use of "church" (English) or "ecclesia" (Grk). Five times in our passage!

It was a particularly suitable title for the Christian congregation as the successor to the OT congregation of Israel-- in so far as it drew heavily on the LXX use of *ecclesia* to denote the assembly of Yahweh (Dt. 23:1-2, 1Chron.28:8, Neh.13:1, Mic.2:5, etc) This was the word in the GRK OT that was used most often to describe Israel in its assembled context!

IT IS ALSO NOTEWORTHY TO NOTE THAT PAUL USES THE TERM ALMOST EXCLUSIVELY, IF NOT EXCLUSIVELY (ONLY EPH. IS DEBATABLE) TO DENOTE A LOCAL ASSEMBLY OF CHRISTIANS AND NEVER FOR "THE CHURCH UNIVERSAL."

Hence the plurals in 16:16, 1Cor.7:17, 16:1, 19, 2Cor.8:18-19, 23-24...

This is huge if we stop and think about it relative to priesthood doctrine—there is something that Phoebe is called to do for the church, that is important enough that Paul would give a formal recommendation to the church in order that they would assist her in her work in whatever ways she needed...

This so called "work" of ordinary people is a work that is directly linked to a temple theology...

And to be sure, no one reading this letter as especially from the Jewish context would then think of this work and service as non-important or secondary to other work in their lives... in so far as the "church" is the New Covenant temple of God and as such is an essential element of God's salvation plan for this people!

Application:

We all love the sermons that remind us about how much God loves us, the great and amazing gains that we have in Christ as by faith alone in God's perfect and sovereign grace... as we should!

And to be sure, these form the "indicatives" of our lives—those truths we must never forget, those truths that inform our identity and our understanding of selfworth, self acceptance as then predicated upon the worth granted to us in Christ by faith alone!

We love to hear about the kind of love that God has for his people and indeed, a kind of love that has nothing whatsoever to do with our love, our work, our morals, our service even... not can we forget this!

However, Just as Romans then brings us to a "therefore" in Romans 12 as followed then with imperative for living—so must we, on occasion, here a sermon on these imperative—imperative that fill out the meaning of our being called into a saving relationship with Christ...

This is such a sermon... lest we forget that like romans' our Christian life is a life that is not only "indicative" of God's work, but should then result in the imperatives of a life that is now more and more holy, more and more given to service God...

E.G. Having described the humiliation of Christ in his sacrificial and humble service for our salvation, together with the exaltation of Christ ... (indicatives) Paul then says immediately following

Phil. 2:12

Therefore, my beloved, just as you have always obeyed me, not only in my presence, but much more now in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling; 13 for it is God who is at work in you, enabling you both to will and to work for his good pleasure.

THEREFORE, AS CONCERNING THE "CHURCH WORK"

1. We cannot think of "church work" as "secondary work in relation to our other "work"!"

We live in very interesting times relative to the whole notion of "calling."

For it is true, that during the medieval era, the idea of "calling" and therefore "sacred" and "important" as regarding "work" was largely limited to church related work... thus, to be a priest was falsely passed off as the only high and sacred way to serve God...

Thankfully, the reformers clarified the apostolic tradition such as to demonstrate that all service, both public service, family service AND church service, are "callings" relative to God's mandate for humanity...

This notion, in the passing of time, became known as the "Protestant work ethic"-- in its earlier forms, it was an "ethic" that affirmed all service to God as related to both the "common good" and the good of the redeemed...

But in around the early 20th century especially, the Protestant "work" ethic was secularized as from its divine calling, even as it was individualized in terms of its focus... The Protestant work ethic became expressive individualism—whereby public service became "career" and work, or "important" work was that work we do to serve ourselves and our own personal interests...

In short, if there was a false dichotomy between "sacred and secular" where "important work was in the church during the medieval era—there is now a reverse false dichotomy—where the new "sacred" or "important" work is "career" such that it is very hard to hear a sermon like this and not view it with some degree of skepticism...

Paul's point in Romans 12, as illustrated in Romans 16—is that the NT temple of God wherein the means of grace are distributed to the elect is a temple run not by a specific tribe of Christians, as in the OT "levites" but is run by "believers" thus... the priesthood of

all believers— *Even as all believers have direct access to God through Christ—so too all believers have direct service to God through Christ!*

And THAT THIS WORK IS NOT SECONDARY, BUT RATHER IMPORTANT, EVEN AS WORK IN THE FAMILY AND PUBLIC SPHERES ARE IMPORTANT!

Illus: Service as an act of worship and “anointing” as did the nameless women in Mark

Mark 14:3

While he was at Bethany in the house of Simon the leper, as he sat at the table, a woman came with an alabaster jar of very costly perfume of nard, and she broke open the jar and poured the ointment on his head. 4 But some were there who said to one another in anger, “Why was the ointment wasted in this way? 5 For this ointment could have been sold for more than three hundred denarii, and the money given to the poor.” And they scolded her. 6 But Jesus said, “Let her alone; why do you trouble her? She has performed a good service for me. 7 For you always have the poor with you, and you can show kindness to them whenever you wish; but you will not always have me. 8 She has done what she could; she has anointed my body beforehand for its burial. 9 Truly I tell you, wherever the good news is proclaimed in the whole world, what she has done will be told in remembrance of her.”

Notice:

1) “Service” was an act of worship in response to the purpose of Christ in his sacrificial death for our sins! Eg. This whole event is framed in the context of Christ’s sacrificial death for the purpose of serving God’s purpose to redeem for himself a people saved by grace!

2) Her worship in service was not recognized as important to the disciples relative to other services—they saw the usefulness of her gifts and especially her precious wealth as more useful in worldly terms—even as a common grace

(public service)... so too today—the work we do for the church is not readily recognized by the world as important—its at best “volunteer” work that is done after the real work is done...

But in servicing the church, we serve the bride of Christ, we serve even Christ himself as he is mediated through the means of grace given to the church...

3. Her service was therefore extremely costly—as the price here noted is in 1st century terms equal to an annual wage!!!

2) A Necessary Caveat:

Assuming you have been convinced by the exegesis—that you are to make room in your life and your financial plan to “serve” the church as a priest of God in the NT temple, sadly, you will be forced to do this in a world that DOESN’T recognize this sphere of work—your employer will most likely not make room for this in his/her expectations of your production... your coach won’t, your teacher won’t.. etc.

It IS VERY hard to do this and also be successful in the world! So what are we to do—on the one hand, we want to be successful even in the noblest of motivations... and on the other hand, we want to have room in our lives for three spheres...

All I can say is what the Bible says-

- 1) That your “calling” is to make room for the three spheres—albeit in individualized ways relative to your lives...
- 2) That it shouldn’t surprise you if this lifestyle will put you in an upstream context with the rest of the world... and that you will therefore “suffer” as a Christian in this world.. even as Christ promised to all faithful Christians.
- 3) Your great reward will be awaiting you—there is a payoff, perhaps in this life as you see the redeeming work of God freeing you more and more from the bondage of your idols... but certainly in the world to come when you are finally glorified with Christ in heaven, even as you were humiliated with Christ on earth!

In summary:

As you know, it is an incredibly wonderful privilege to *know* Christ! For to know Christ is first of all to be fully *known* by Him whereby we are fully accepted by God's grace and entered into the household of God as adopted sons and daughters! (Rom. 8) Furthermore, to really *know* Christ is to share in His work as applied to *us* even as we also share in his work as applied to others *through us*. This was Paul's point in Philippians 3, that having been known by Christ, he desired to more fully know him by sharing in his service to the church in the present age. You might say that we know Christ when we put on Christ by faith, and with thanksgiving in our hearts to God, when we put Christ upon one another in service to God. Again, notice how Paul says it in Romans 12. Having discerned the great benefits of being known by Christ as through our justification and adoption earlier in the letter, he then encourages the members of that church to serve God by serving one another. He says,

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that you present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your reasonable service... 5 for we, being many, are one body in Christ, and individually members of one another. 6 Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us, let us use them ...9 Let love be without hypocrisy... 10 Be kindly affectionate to one another with brotherly love, in honor giving preference to one another; 11 not lagging in diligence, fervent in spirit, serving the Lord; ...13 distributing to the needs of the saints, given to hospitality.

Really, what is your service in the Lord as related to his NT temple?

What role do you play—are you presenting yourselves as a living sacrifice to God... a reasonable service!

6 Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us, let us use them

3. So what is a *Servant* Leader... A leader who in God's way of thinking, understands that *The way up is the way down --*

Our Frame of Mind:

Matt. 23:11 The greatest among you will be your servant.

Mark 9:35 He sat down, called the twelve, and said to them, "Whoever wants to be first must be last of all and servant of all."

Mark 10:43 But it is not so among you; but whoever wishes to become great among you must be your servant,

Our Example:

Mark 10:45 For the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life a ransom for many."

Our goal:

Eph. 3:7 Of this gospel I have become a servant according to the gift of God's grace that was given me by the working of his power.

Col. 4:12 Epaphras, who is one of you, a servant of Christ Jesus, greets you. He is always wrestling in his prayers on your behalf, so that you may stand mature and fully assured in everything that God wills.

Our motivation:

Eph. 6:7 Render service with enthusiasm, as to the Lord and not to men and women,

It is, in the highest sense, a noble vocation to be a servant leader in the church.

The Servant leader is someone who follows in the pattern of Christ—where greatness is judged by humble service, less accolades, popularity, success in the world's way of defining it... I think of this teenager, as yet out of high school, who just received the most lucrative deal in history to represent Nike... What was it for—the ability to entertain ... What will it serve—selfish individualism...greed, prestige, celebrityism

E.g.

Who does the world exalt?

Who is exalted in the Kingdom of God...

We should then consider Christ, and his pattern to be our own, even as we approach now His sacred table...

We should remember the word so Paul in Philip...

3 Do nothing from selfish ambition or conceit, but in humility regard others as better than yourselves. 4 Let

each of you look not to your own interests, but to the interests of others. 5 Let the same mind be in you that was in Christ Jesus,

6 who, though he was in the form of God,
did not regard equality with God
as something to be exploited,

7 but emptied himself,
taking the form of a slave,
being born in human likeness.

And being found in human form,
8 he humbled himself
and became obedient to the point of
death—
even death on a cross.

□

Phil. 2:9

Therefore God also highly exalted him
and gave him the name
that is above every name,
10 so that at the name of Jesus
every knee should bend,
in heaven and on earth and under the earth,
11 and every tongue should confess
that Jesus Christ is Lord,
to the glory of God the Father.

Phil. 2:12

Therefore, my beloved, just as you have always obeyed me,
not only in my presence, but much more now in my
absence, work out your own salvation with fear and
trembling; 13 for it is God who is at work in you,
enabling you both to will and to work for his good
pleasure.